

We Have the Nature of God Our Father

When God opened up the Born-Again Trail, there was quite a joke around here for a period of time:

"You are going to teach a bunch of preachers on being saved?"

I said, "No, it is not like that."

The first thing God did on that trail was open up the law. I could understand where Paul was coming from when he was so strong that he would say statements like:

"Who hath bewitched you?"

Certain teachers from James came down, and they were going to teach the people that in order to be saved, they had to be circumcised. Judaism was this: the Gentile was accepted into the inheritance of Abraham when he was born again, but to be perfected, he had to go on and keep the law.

At that point, all they were introducing was circumcision. But Paul's point was that if they believed they had to be circumcised to be saved, they had stepped into another gospel. So he said, "Who has bewitched you?"

Just taking that first step down that trail, he was vehemently and violently opposed to it.

To the Gentile, Paul took us back to Adam and said that through one man's transgression sin entered the world and death by sin. Then came the second Adam.

But to the Jew, whom God established with the law as a schoolmaster, the point Paul had to contend with was that the law could not save them.

When God opened up the law and I understood where the Jew came from and how free we were, I took my next step into freedom after He showed me the Born-Again Trail and who I had become by a new nature.

When I understood that the heart of the law was the Ten Commandments, and that the Ten Commandments were actually fulfilled by the new nature, I saw that they could now keep it, not by precept and animal sacrifice, but by nature.

That became the springboard by which I began to see how absolutely free He had made me. The more I understand, moment by moment, what happened to me in my nature, the freer I become.

When I was teaching as much as I could in the early service in New York, at one point the freedom settled in so predominantly in those people that we lost control of them. They screamed, yelled, marched, and ran. It took me five to ten minutes to resume teaching. I could not get them calmed

down.

Under the shadow, Solomon's wisdom was a type. He operated in the shadow of the rebirth. Yet what wisdom was to Solomon's reign, our new nature is to our spirit.

Moses said, "I will know God." God picked him up and put him in the rock. That rock was a type of the Rock He put you in when you would know God as your Father, Abba.

God cleft the rock and put Moses in it. The day you said, "I will know God," you were born again. That rock was a type of Christ. But because Moses was unregenerated and had a sin nature, the closest thing you could say about those under the Old Covenant is that they were saved in waiting for the promise.

Every prophet, every teacher, Moses, and even Adam waited for that promise. When God said that one born of woman would come and destroy the headship of Satan, all of Scripture pointed to Him. Jesus told the Jews:

"Search the scriptures;
for in them ye think ye have eternal life:
and they are they which testify of me."

All the Scriptures spoke of Him.

In Jerusalem, when I saw the old gate Abraham came through on one of his journeys, I almost broke down and wept. It was because of the Born-Again Trail that He had just introduced me to.

They had uncovered those old eroded gates and said Abraham undoubtedly passed through them on one of his journeys when the city was there. Then the Lord said to me, "Your born-again experience passed through these gates. Your promise passed through here."

All the shadows and types spoke of Him.

Paul was very clear in Colossians: once the thing making the shadow is here, why would you try to live in the shadow and the thing making the shadow, which is the Body of Christ, at the same time?

Moses said, "I will see God." He was unregenerated. Just like the man who steadied the Ark of the Covenant, reached out and touched it, and died, a spiritually dead man cannot touch the glory of God. It will kill him.

You can.

God cleft the shadow, the rock, and put Moses in it. Moses said, "I will see You, God." When God went by, He had to cover Moses so He could pass by.

Not you.

When you said, "I will see God," He picked you up and did not put you in the shadow. He put you in the Rock Himself. You were born again. When He passed by, He did not cover you with the cleft of His hand. He stopped when He was even with you and stepped in. You were filled with the Holy Ghost.

Do you have any idea who you are? Do you have any idea of the potential you have yet?

You are the sons and daughters of God with an inheritance.

When you were adopted, He made it very plain that in this adoption you received His nature. That is where we are heading this morning.

He wanted you to understand that in your adoption, He gave you His nature. He said some absolutely incredible things.

So in the study of this nature, where we are heading will be Galatians 4. Put a marker there if you want, and we will pass in review for a moment.

Are you listening to me? You have been born again. Hallelujah. You have been born again.

Back to 1 Corinthians 2:12:

"Now we have received,
not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God;
that we might know
the things that are freely given to us
of God."

You did not receive the spirit of the world. That is the unregenerated human spirit and the spiritual death in it that you inherited from the first man Adam.

You do not have that one anymore. That is not the one you received from God. Now that you are born again, you do not have that spirit anymore. You do not even have anything that resembles it.

What did we get from God?

"The spirit which is of God."

The word "spirit" has a little "s." Paul is talking about the human spirit, not the Holy Spirit. Everybody makes that out to be the Holy Spirit, but again, it is not. It is talking about your human spirit.

We did not receive the spirit that is of the world, the one the first man Adam gave us, but the spirit which is of God. That is the born-again human spirit with the nature of Christ in it, the one from God.

Now that you have His nature, Paul says:

"That we might know
the things that are freely given to us
of God."

When you were spiritually dead, you had no capacity to understand the things of God because you did not have a nature that could understand God.

First Corinthians 2:14 talks about that spiritually dead state:

"But the natural man receiveth not
the things of the Spirit of God:
for they are foolishness unto him:
neither can he know them,
because they are spiritually discerned."

The natural man is the natural unregenerated man with spiritual death in his spirit. He cannot receive the things of the Spirit of God. They are foolishness to him. Neither can he know them, because they are spiritually discerned.

There is no way a spiritually dead man can understand the things that are of the nature of God as pertaining to our sonship. They are spiritually derived, understood, and received. You cannot discern them with your head.

That word "discern" is stronger than knowledge, details, or intellect. The word discern belongs to nature. If you do not have His nature, you have nothing to discern with.

When Mama Piranha took little Baby Piranha away from Adopted Mama Goldfish, they went down the Amazon for the cows to cross. She said, "Okay, little Jeffrey Dahmer."

That was little Baby Piranha's name, because when Mama Goldfish adopted him, she would pull his little diaper down and beat him every week, trying to beat a new nature into him. She knew he was doing something at night he should not be doing, like most teenagers. She would pull his little diaper down and beat it every week, trying to get him to quit, but she could not because he had the nature of a piranha.

Then Mama Piranha came back, took possession, and they went down the river. The cows were crossing. She said, "Okay, son, this is what we are going to do."

He said, "Never mind, Mom. I have been sneaking out and doing that all my life. One day I just started eating my goldfish friends. I could not help it."

You did not have to teach him that. He had that nature.

Nature is not your intellect. It is not your emotions. It is not your will. It is a nature by which you understand what motivates you.

You have been born again. You have the nature of God. You are now equipped to know the things that have been freely given to you.

Then He sent us a Teacher who, like the other members of the Godhead, has that same nature. I now have the nature of Christ. That means I have the nature of Jehovah, who is now my Father. I also have the same nature within my spirit that the Holy Spirit has.

Would it not seem fitting that He would step into you to become your Teacher and to lead and guide you into all truth?

The natural man in the first half of 1 Corinthians 2:12 can only understand the things of spiritual death. He cannot understand these things that are of God.

What man knows the things of men, unregenerated men, except the spirit of man that is in him? Who can know the things of God except that regenerated spirit in him?

When I was bound by spiritual death, that was my nature. How could I explore anything outside of it? I had no inroad, no capacity. There was no way to know things outside my spiritual death because I could not discern them.

The day I got born again, I received His nature and a capacity to discern. God looked at me and said, "Now I am going to give him the Teacher."

By my invitation, the greatest of all Teachers stepped into my spirit.

Then I said, "I am still too dumb to know what He wants exactly."

So He established a canon of Scripture and put it in my lap.

I said, "I am still too dumb."

So He gave me a supernatural language of heaven to pray the mysteries of Christ against the day He can reveal them to me.

I have been inoculated against failure.

No wonder He will take your reward away when you justify your failures. I am going to be taught. I am going to let myself be taught. I am going to give myself over. I am going to trade this vapor He calls the duration of my life.

I am going to strive to get past servant, which is minister. The servant is the minister of godly things. I am going to strive to get past that to what the King James translated as servant, though the original word is slave.

King James translated "slave" as "servant," and translated "servant" as "minister." Jesus said:

"He that is great among you
shall be your minister."

That is servant.

He also said the one who comes in first, let him be your servant, meaning slave. The first will be last, and the last will be first. Many are called, but few are chosen.

Those who make themselves first in this kingdom come in last. If you rob self-exaltation, glory, and money from men, have a good time. It will be over soon.

Those who make themselves last, the servants and slaves in His kingdom, come in first.

My call is sovereign. So is yours. In God's omniscience, all-knowing without time, He chose what you would be in the kingdom and chose salvation for you. But in His sovereignty, your will comes in. You can do anything you want.

I choose. I choose. It is my choice. I choose to follow what He predestined for me in sovereignty.

Everything you are looking for, from peace to joy unspeakable and full of glory, belongs only to that realm.

Thank God I have a new nature, and now I can freely know the things that are of the Spirit of God.

First Corinthians 2:12 says:

"Now we have received,
not the spirit of the world,
but the spirit which is of God;
that we might know
the things that are freely given to us
of God."

We received the born-again, regenerated hidden man of the heart, the new creation spirit which is of God, that we might know the things freely given to us of God.

Verse 13 says:

"Which things also we speak,
not in the words
which man's wisdom teacheth,
but which the Holy Ghost teacheth;
comparing spiritual things
with spiritual."

What things? The things freely given to us of God.

Paul, the apostle who gave the foundation to the Church, says the things we can know of God and that are freely given to us are the things we speak and teach. But we do not teach them in the words man's wisdom teaches. We teach them in the words and wisdom the Holy Ghost teaches.

How does He teach?

"Comparing spiritual things with spiritual."

Paul says he is teaching in the words and wisdom the Holy Ghost teaches by comparing spiritual things with spiritual. The words the Holy Ghost used to teach him to compare spiritual things with spiritual are the same revelation Paul was trying to teach the Church.

When you pray in tongues, it is like money as a medium of exchange. You can take a hundred acres and convert it into something temporary. The power of that hundred acres, what it is worth, is transferred into a medium of exchange. You can put it in a little jar, take it out later, and convert it back into land.

The mysteries you pray in the Holy Ghost are the mystery of the understanding of everything Christ is in you and to you, the hope of glory.

God has all the spiritual things we need to understand. The medium of exchange that pulls it out of God and causes us to understand it by our spirit is that supernatural language of prayer when we pray the mysteries of Christ.

It is not very long before a transfer begins to take place. That is why you are edified. I begin to understand the things of God. I begin to discern them because the Holy Ghost begins to compare the spiritual things of God to the part of me that can understand them, which is my new nature.

To compare spiritual things with spiritual, the second party, which is you, has to have something already in place. Otherwise, there is nothing to compare spiritual things to.

When you were born again, you were translated out of darkness into the kingdom of light and His dear Son. You did not come into the kingdom of God knowing everything, but you did come into the kingdom with a new nature, just like God's, so you could be taught and understand spiritual things.

That is the only thing the Holy Spirit has to work with.

What do you have three seconds after coming into the kingdom that He can compare spiritual things to? What do I have that I can understand them with?

A new nature. That is the thing about me the Holy Spirit finds that is like my Father.

It is like slipping a duck egg into a chicken's nest. He hatches, they are all eating and running around, and they get too near the pond. Then baby duck breaks for the pond, jumps in, and swims off. The mother hen is on the shore, cackling, calling it back, and having a fit. She cannot understand it, but he can, because he received a nature like Mama Duck.

The chicken has no way of understanding it. For the chicken, there is sheer fear at the bank of the water. Not for the duck.

It is incredible where you find this new nature. God wanted you to know that when you were adopted, when you were spiritually dead and He came along and adopted you, it was not like Mama Goldfish and Baby Piranha, where she tried to beat a new nature into him.

He wanted you to know how far your adoption went. He wanted you to know that when you were adopted, you received His nature.

When they kept trying to go back under the law, Paul used the freedom of the new nature to prevent them from doing so. When I saw that, it brought me to a whole other level of freedom. I am so free I can hardly stand myself.

With embarrassment, I look back on the early days when God told me to stop and receive an outpouring here. For some self-exalted reason, I thought the whole reason He asked me to do it was because of my fervent understanding of prayer.

The closer you get to God, the more you understand that fear is the beginning of wisdom. I am talking about the awesome respect due Him when you start seeing by revelation who He really is.

The closer I pull to Him, the less I find out I knew. The earlier I was in my born-again experience, the more I thought I knew. The more I pull into Him and see Him, the less I find out I know. And that is only the part of Him that has to do with humanity.

Do you understand how much more there is to Him? We get a peek at what pertains to us, but He has a whole life out there. You cannot see the end of creation. You are just a little bitty thing here, and He changed Himself for your redemption and called you His son. You have a big part of His life.

He existed outside of time before anything was created. In the beginning, before anything had a beginning, He simply was. He already lived forever before you came along.

There is no way to know how big He is. There is only one thing you can know: you are His son and His daughter, and the part He gave to you is yours.

I have His nature. Glory be to God. I can discern spiritual things.

Now go to Galatians 3:23:

"But before faith came,
we were kept under the law,
shut up unto the faith
which should afterwards be revealed."

Verse 24:

"Wherefore the law was our schoolmaster
to bring us unto Christ,
that we might be justified by faith."

Verse 25:

"But after that faith is come,
we are no longer under a schoolmaster."

Verse 26:

"For ye are all the children of God
by faith in Christ Jesus."

As many as have been baptized into Christ have put on Christ. There is neither Jew nor Greek, slave nor free, male nor female, for you are all one in Christ. If you be Christ's, then you are Abraham's seed and heirs according to the promise.

Yes, there is male and female in heaven. You will be the same gender when you arrive. When Paul says there is neither male nor female, it is because your new nature does not have a gender. I have been born again.

Paul was contending with Jews and Judaizers who were trying to bring the Gentile Galatians under the law. Using his own coming out from under the law, out from under the schoolmaster, receiving His nature, and being justified by faith, he argued with them.

"You want to go back under the law? I came out from under it. Listen to what I have to say about the law."

Galatians 4:1 says:

"Now I say,
That the heir,
as long as he is a child,
differeth nothing from a servant,
though he be lord of all."

The Greek word for servant here is slave. He is talking about a household that had heirs, but also had slaves. Ultimately, he is talking about the house of God. The Jew was the natural heir and stood to inherit the promise, but the natural heir was no different than the slave in the household because both had the sin nature.

The Jew, who was the natural heir, had spiritual death in him. The slave to sin also had spiritual death in him.

That is why Jesus said:

"Whosoever committeth sin
is the servant of sin.
And the servant abideth not
in the house for ever:
but the Son abideth ever.
If the Son therefore shall make you free,
ye shall be free indeed."

They said, "We are Abraham's seed. We were never in bondage to any man."

He said, "He that sins is the slave to sin, but he whom the Son sets free is free indeed."

Unless you have the attributes the schoolmaster taught through the Ten Commandments, attributes that free you from sin, you are not going to enter into the inheritance of the Father.

Paul says that the natural heir, as long as he was a child, differed nothing from the slave in the household, though he was lord of all. He stood to inherit all as the natural heir, but he was no different than the slave.

Verse 2 says:

"But is under tutors and governors
until the time appointed of the father."

Verse 3 says:

"Even so we,
when we were children,
were in bondage
under the elements of the world."

What bondage is he talking about? Verse 9 tells you:

"But now,
after that ye have known God,
or rather are known of God,
how turn ye again
to the weak and beggarly elements,
whereunto ye desire again
to be in bondage?
Ye observe days,
and months,
and times,
and years."

So when Paul says they were in bondage under the elements of the world, he is talking about those days, months, times, years, Sabbaths, seasons, and new moons.

Galatians 4:4 says:

"But when the fulness of the time was come,
God sent forth his Son,
made of a woman,
made under the law."

Verse 5:

"To redeem them that were under the law,
that we might receive
the adoption of sons."

The heir, the natural heir, Abraham's seed, was no different than the slave in the household. He stood to inherit the promise, but the Jew was as spiritually dead as the Gentile.

So God said, "In order for you to inherit, O Israel, you have to be under a tutor." The tutor or governor is like the law becoming the schoolmaster. This tutor came to the household and taught the person individually.

"You are going to grow up and inherit what your father has for you. These are the attributes you have to have, or you cannot inherit all your father has. I have been sent as a governor to teach you the attributes you must have to inherit your father's inheritance."

The thing God used, the heart of the law, the standard, was the Ten Commandments. That was the standard Moses came down the mountain with. That was the heart of the law.

When God took the old tablets of stone and wrote the Ten Commandments with His finger, those stones were a type of the stony, spiritually dead heart of unregenerated man.

God took the Ten Commandments and wrote them in those tablets that represented the unregenerated Jew. Then He commanded the Jew to keep them. He said, "To inherit, you have to be able to keep this law," and wrote it in their spiritually stony, dead hearts.

So this governor came to Israel, who stood to inherit, and said, "You have to have these attributes or you cannot inherit what your Father has for you."

He began to teach what was inscribed in their heart as spiritually dead men:

"Thou shalt have no other gods before me."
"Thou shalt not make unto thee any graven image."
"Thou shalt not take the name of the Lord thy God in vain."
"Remember the sabbath day, to keep it holy."
"Honour thy father and thy mother."
"Thou shalt not kill."
"Thou shalt not commit adultery."
"Thou shalt not steal."
"Thou shalt not bear false witness."
"Thou shalt not covet."

If you do not have these attributes working in you, you cannot inherit.

They tried. But God had to add animal sacrifice because the only way they could keep those Ten Commandments was to sacrifice an animal when their failure was laid on it in their place.

That is why Paul said:

"Is the law sin? God forbid.
Nay, I had not known sin,
but by the law:
for I had not known lust,
except the law had said,
Thou shalt not covet."

A spiritually dead man has no way of knowing anything outside his death nature. When the schoolmaster stepped up and said, "Thou shalt not covet," he tried to stop and could not. His nature was to eat the cow when it fell into the Amazon. They just could not quit doing it.

When the fullness of time came, Jesus came, born of woman and born under the law. Because He was born of woman and born under the law, He was obligated to keep the law.

The difference between Him and every other person ever born under the law is that He was the first man to be born spiritually alive. When it came time to inherit, He was the first man with a nature that could keep the law, not by precept and animal sacrifice, but by the nature given to Him by His Father.

He fulfilled the law. He died for the Jew, fulfilled it as the last sacrifice, and fulfilled it by the new nature because He could keep the law. Then He stepped into every Jew's shoes who could not keep it, became the curse of the law, and was hung on a tree. He freed every Jew from the curse of the law to receive the same adoption you and I received when we were born again, received the nature of our Father, inherited eternal life, and entered the household of God forever.

Was I yelling? I guess I was.

Did you get that?

Galatians 4:4-5 says:

"But when the fulness of the time was come,
God sent forth his Son,
made of a woman,
made under the law,
to redeem them
that were under the law,
that we might receive
the adoption of sons."

Then verse 6 says:

"And because ye are sons,
God hath sent forth
the Spirit of his Son
into your hearts,
crying,
Abba, Father."

That should be a little "s." It is not talking about the Holy Spirit. Because you are sons, God sent forth the nature of His Son into your hearts crying, "Abba, Abba, You are my Father."

He wanted you to know that in your adoption, unlike when Mama Goldfish adopted Baby Piranha and could not beat a new nature into him, you received the nature of His Son.

He wants you to know that your adoption was not God adopting something of another species and tolerating it. Because you are sons, He sent forth the nature of His Son, by which, out of that nature, you can cry, "You are my Father."

Then Paul uses that nature as an argument:

Why, now that you have been adopted by a new nature, would you want to bring yourself back under bondage to the elements of the world, under things that by nature are not gods?

Verses 6 and 7 are one thought:

"And because ye are sons,
God hath sent forth
the Spirit of his Son
into your hearts,
crying,
Abba, Father.
Wherefore thou art no more a servant,
but a son;
and if a son,
then an heir of God through Christ."

Because of this, you are no more a slave to sin, but a son. If a son, you have the full inheritance of your Father.

Galatians 4:8 says:

"Howbeit then,
when ye knew not God,
ye did service unto them
which by nature are no gods."

When you did not know God because of your sin nature, you did service to things which by nature had nothing to do with God's nature or with becoming His son.

Verse 9 says:

"But now,
after that ye have known God,
or rather are known of God,
how turn ye again
to the weak and beggarly elements,
whereunto ye desire again
to be in bondage?"

Now that you have known God, or rather now are known of God because He made you His son, how do you turn again to the weak and beggarly elements, desiring again to be in bondage?

Verse 10 says:

"Ye observe days,
and months,
and times,
and years."

Paul says:

"I am afraid of you,
lest I have bestowed upon you
labour in vain."

What does God's nature have to do with observing a day under the shadow? Once He who is making the shadow is here, the Body of Christ into which you have been baptized by a new nature, why would you want to go serve back in things that have no nature: days, sacrifices, years, new moons, Sabbaths, things that do not themselves have nature and have nothing to do with a son and God?

Why serve things that are ordinances, precepts, and laws, which in themselves have no nature, now that you have known God by a new nature and He has known you by that nature?

A friend of mine from long ago and I had to separate years back because my vision would not fit in hers. I just could not go do any more meetings.

I used to think that when somebody in the Church starts getting full of revelation knowledge and cannot fit anymore, maybe they are the limb God cuts off the tree. But now I have found out that truth is truth by merit of truth alone. Truth is not little truth or big truth. Truth is truth.

It does not matter if ten million people are wrong and you get popped out because you are right. You are the tree. They are the dead limb that got cut off of you.

Quantity means nothing.

Hallelujah.

The Hasidic Jews at the Wailing Wall are waiting for the Messiah to come and deliver them. If you have ever seen them pray, it is with fervency. I have been there at the Wailing Wall and watched them. These are people who keep the Sabbath and probably some Passover things.

Someone tried to tell me one time that the Holy Spirit swept through and the Hasidic Jews at the Wailing Wall began to speak with tongues.

I said, "Excuse me. When you get born again, they disown you, bury you, disinherit you, and your name is not mentioned anymore. You are telling me they are speaking with tongues?"

Excuse me.

Lately one of those has been spearheading the gold dust. People go into services and are coated with gold dust, shaking it out of their hair. My old friend from years ago is kind of spearheading that in our nation. You migrate to that camp meeting, where I preached in the past, to get a dose. Then once you come back with the flecks on you, it usually begins in your church.

You get a bunch of people with no foundation, coat them with a little bit of gold, and you have them chasing signs and wonders. Something like that will separate you immediately from your foundation because you will just keep trying to make God do more sensational things.

I understand the next evolution of gold dusting is people starting to fly, lifting up out of their seats.

That is okay. Just stay with the Word.

In documented history, there have been many testimonies of priests flying up to kiss the statue of the Virgin and flying back down. Stay with Him.

I do not want to worship any created thing.

Why would I observe days or anything else that by nature is not God? If I am worshiping Him out of the pureness of the nature He gave me, and gold covers me, please do not come bother me about the gold. It will leave me soon enough because I am not going to receive it.

Do not bother me when I am worshiping out of a nature like His. He and I are in fellowship and communion. I am not going to stop to admire anything in creation.

Let me worship Him in pureness and in truth.

"What is the type of the glory of God?"

I do not want the type. I can have the real.

If I have been coated, am I damaged or something? Are you kidding? Give the devil an E and fail him for effort. Greater is He that is in me than he that is in the world. If there is something stronger, let me know, because that means I am limited in what I can do.

But I know my Father. I know Him by nature, and I know Him by inheritance. Therefore, we do not have to be stopped.

Lift those hands, sons and daughters of God. Remember, you are out of those things which by nature are not God. You do not have to worship any created thing.

It is you and Him.

He has waited and sought you out. He says He is seeking such to worship Him. He is looking for you. God does not look for much, but for this, He is looking for you. He is seeking you. He wants something from you, a fellowship only possible through that nature.

So do not stop with creation. For God's sake, go past it. It took Him enough to redeem you and pay for it. Go past creation. Leave the days alone.

Some say, "This is the natural jubilee. Send all your money in because you are going to magically be free of debt."

You were free of debt thirty seconds after He said, "It is finished." You do not need anything else. If those ploys worked, everybody would be out of debt. They have had so many of them.

Are you listening to me?

I am charged by God to get you to heaven with a reward. We are going. And not only are we going; we are dragging this city with us.

Once we take one city, it will be easier to take the next one. We are dragging cities with us.

Tonight, calling in the lost, we are dragging a city with us.